

Hardness Evidence Lab

I can use the same stated scratch method to compare four coded rock samples and give a cautious evidence-based conclusion.

LOCK

fair method

KEEP

no cherry-picking

CONCLUDE

name a limit

[Open the original interactive lesson](#)

What success looks like

- I can record an after-wipe result for all four codes.
- I can keep every valid result, including an unexpected one.
- I can compare relative scratch resistance and state one method or sample limitation.

Retrieve and reconnect

- Define relative hardness using scratch resistance.
- Name three controls in the stated method.
- Explain why the first pale line is not yet the final observation.
- Lead-in: state why every valid result must stay in the table.

Codes A–D give four different after-wipe results. Which recording rule protects the evidence?

Think first. Point, say, sign or write your choice. Give one reason.

- A. Keep every valid result and note any safety stop or repeat.
- B. Keep only the result that matches the prediction.
- C. Choose harder until all four grooves are equally deep.

Look closely · what is the evidence?

CODE A · deep groove remains

CODE B · shallow groove remains; loose grain triggers a check

CODES C–D · faint groove / no groove after wiping

Look closely · what is the evidence?

SAME TOOL
SAME GUIDE
SAME PASSES
ONLY THE SAMPLE CHANGES



The locked method: same tool, guide and passes

Code A · line gone
Code C · groove
Code D · groove (faint)
Code F · flaked — STOPPED

all four rows kept · nothing crossed out

A results table with all four codes recorded

A is the most scratch-resistant
...under THIS tool and THIS method.
Limit: one tool, one pass count, hand pressure.

A cautious conclusion with its limit

Words we will use

- relative — compared with the others
- repeat — same method again
- conclusion — what the results support

Watch the model

- Lock the method before Code A: same secured tool, dry start, guide length, passes, safe force proxy, wipe and viewing rule.
- Predict, run or reveal, wipe and record one code at a time. Keep the table visible and never alter an earlier result.
- If the method fails or the sample flakes, write the stop note, repair access or setup safely and use a pretested parity result.

Code C gives a faint groove when you predicted no groove. The method was followed safely. What should you do?

- A. Keep the faint-groove result and, if useful, repeat the same method.
 - B. Delete it because it does not match the prediction.
 - C. Choose harder until the groove looks like the expected result.
- Commit to an answer. Show the evidence you used. Listen, then revise if needed.

Build the explanation

- Order only the tested codes by the remaining groove evidence: deeper groove means lower resistance to this scratch method.
- Use a cautious conclusion such as 'Code D resisted a groove more than Code A under this method.'
- Add one limitation: specimens vary, the force proxy is simple and one classroom tool does not produce a universal hardness number.

Find and repair the misconception

Evidence glitch: keep only the deepest and no-groove results because the middle results make the pattern untidy.

A. Keep it: tidy evidence is better than complete evidence.

B. Repair it: keep every valid result so the full relative pattern and variation remain visible.

C. Repair it: invent one average groove and erase the raw observations.

Four-Code Hardness Evidence Matrix

Place each after-wipe result, method card and limitation in its correct evidence role.

- Lock the method.
- Predict one code.
- Record the after-wipe result.
- Keep or repeat without erasing.
- Compare and limit the conclusion.

Four-Code Hardness Evidence Matrix

Use the numbered cards in your pupil pack. Take turns to choose, justify and check. You may direct a partner to move a card.

Choose a group · defend your placement

- DEEP GROOVE
- SHALLOW GROOVE
- FAINT GROOVE
- NO GROOVE AFTER WIPE
- METHOD / REPEAT RULE
- LIMIT OF THE CONCLUSION

State the relative pattern, quote two codes and name one result-handling rule and one limitation.

Your independent mission

Run or direct the same safe scratch method on four coded samples, record every after-wipe result, repeat one check where appropriate and write a cautious conclusion.

Record: A complete four-code raw-results table, one preserved repeat/check note, a relative comparison using at least two codes and one method or sample limitation.

Choose your support and challenge

- Supported: Match four after-wipe picture cards to Codes A–D and complete one two-code comparison.
- Standard: Complete all four rows, keep one repeat/check note and write a conclusion comparing at least two codes.
- Stretch: Evaluate the relative pattern, explain an unexpected result and propose one safe improvement without claiming a universal hardness value.

Show what you know

Use two code results to give a relative-hardness conclusion and state one limit.

Point to, read or explain the evidence you made. Choose one next step after the adult has listened.